



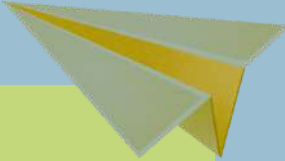
Online Mentoring Programme

GLOBAL YOUTH HACKATHON 2026

1-2 July

#GlobalMILWeek2026



July 1**13:00 - 13:15**

Welcome & Introduction

Min Du, Olivier Van Bockstael

UNESCO MIL Team



THEME:

Play Your Part: Youth Designing the Future of Media and Information Literacy

Who

- Aged 18 to 30
- Participate as a team with 2-6 members
- No prior experience required - only passion and ideas
- Gender balance and inclusion are encouraged
- Align with UNESCO Value

How

- Register for your participation



Final Submission needs:

- A Proposal in Word or PDF format
- A 3-minute pitch video

[LEARN MORE HERE](#)

Why

- Access free online mentoring programme
- Earn a UNESCO Certificate
- Join a global youth community

Highlight of 2026:

Win a trip to Greece 🇬🇷

Shine on a global stage ✨





1. *What are we looking for?*

**Youth-led innovative projects
related to Media and Information
Literacy (MIL)**





2. *Who can participate?*

**Team composed of 2–6 members
aged 18 to 30**



3. *How to start?*

- Understand what is MIL
- Find a problem from your daily life
- Think about your solution

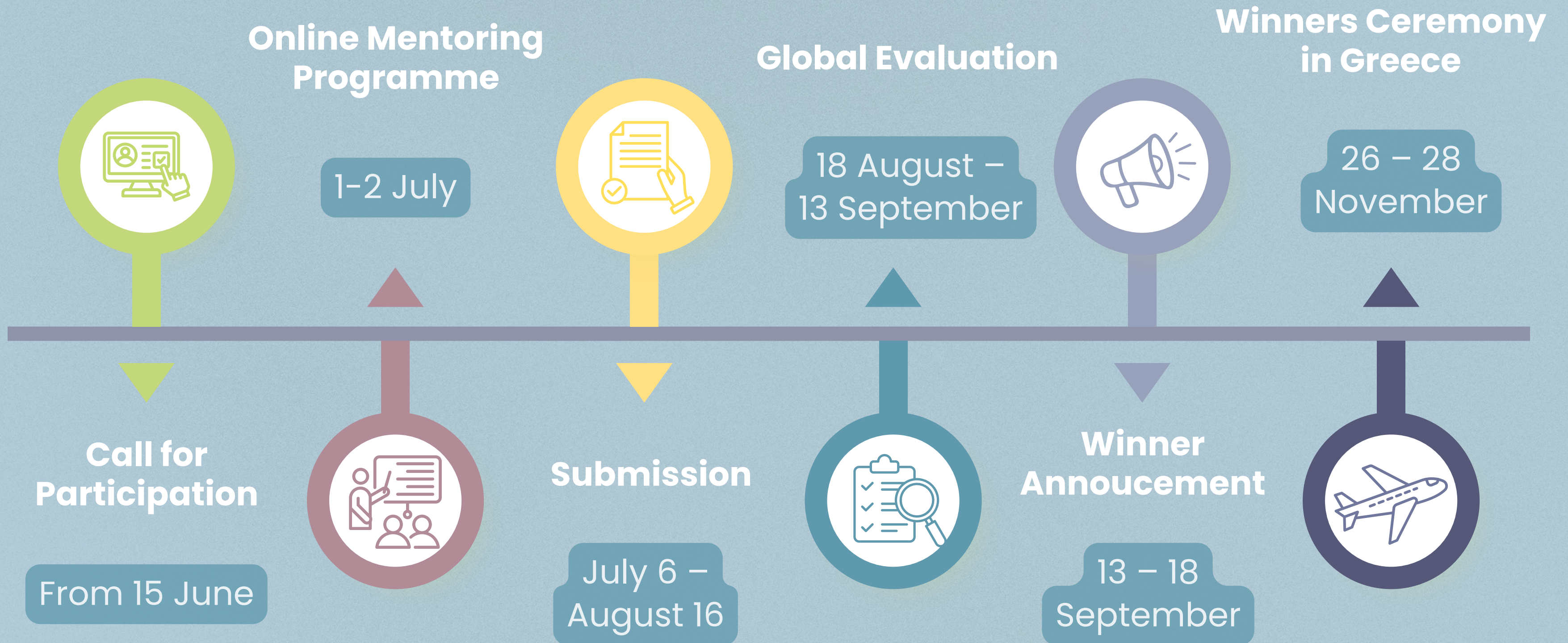


4. *What categories of solutions could be explored?*

Games, applications, websites, radio programmes/podcasts, artistic work (comics, short videos, documentaries), educational toolkits, youth organization campaigns, community-based interventions and other creative modalities for innovative interventions



Timeline



5. *How to submit?*

Submission components:

- **A written proposal**
- **A 3-minute pitch video**





Proposal



- **English only**, submitted in Word/PDF format
- No speical requirement for the structure and format, keep your own style
- You can use slides but ensure to upload the PDF file
- **Key elements included:** team members, problem statement, objectives, target audience, prototype or concept, sustainability, creativity, and feasibility
- Keep it clear, concise, well-structured and readable
- **DO NOT** make it too long



Pitch Video

- Use **maximun 3 minutes** to tell the story behind your project
- No special requirement for the format
- If you use other language, please put the English subtitle
- The content matters most



Submission Process



- **6 July – 16 August (23:59 Paris Time)**
- **Submit your project ONLY through the dedicated platform which will be shared via email afterwards**

Team Profiles

Ensure all information is accurate, especially the contact information

Basic Project Information

- **Name of your proposal**
- **Brief introduction of your proposal**
- **Catogoty of your proposal**

Upload Project

- **Proposal (max 10 MB)**
- **Pitch video (upload to any platform and share the accessible link)**

6. How do we select the winning team?

A group of international experts will review all projects during 18 August to 13 September. Each project will be reviewed by 3 experts, to ensure a fair process.





Evaluation Criteria



- **Consistency with the Theme:**
strong alignment with MLL principles
- **Clarity of Presentation:**
clear communication, strong skills, diversity, and potential to deliver
- **Innovation & Creativity:**
fresh, original, or inventive approach
- **Feasibility & Sustainability:**
realistic, resource-aware, long-term potential
- **Impact & Inclusion:**
addresses a real problem, promotes social good, meets the needs of diverse/marginalized communities



7. How many winning teams?

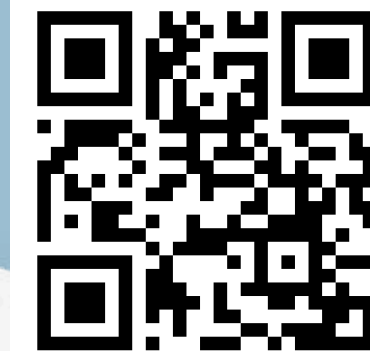
4 winning teams will be selected

The results will be announced at mid of September





8. *What do winning teams receive?*



The winning teams will be invited to **Voice Festival** in Thessaloniki, Greece from November 26–28. UNESCO will cover **2 members** of each team for their flight, accommdation and meal.



9. *What if you don't win?*

All members of a team whose project is successfully submitted and aligns with the Media and Information Literacy (MIL) theme will be able to get a certificate issued by UNESCO.





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#YouthHackathon2026

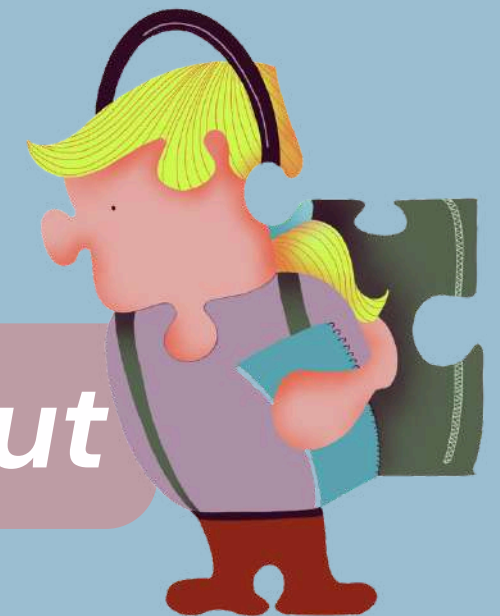
July 1

13:20 – 13:30

What Makes a MIL Idea Stand Out

Cynthia Ebot

Winner of
Youth Hackathon 2025





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#YouthHackathon2026

July 1

13:35 – 14:20



Introduction to MIL – The Basics

Lizette Ferris

DW Akademie





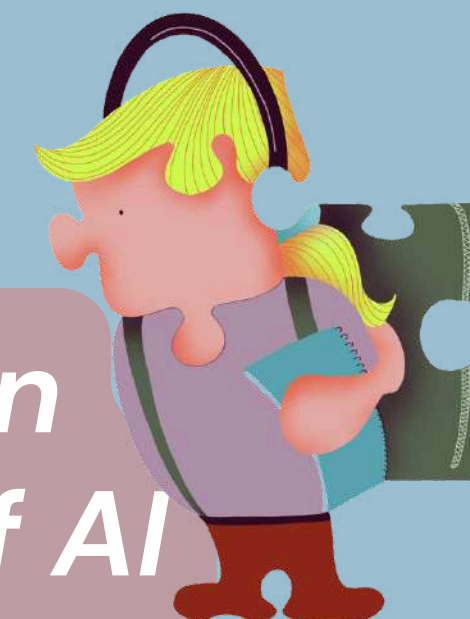
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#YouthHackathon2026

July 1

14:30 – 15:15

***The Trust Challenge:
Hallucination, Misinformation
and False Friends in the Age of AI***



Jenna Khanna

Common Sense Media



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#YouthHackathon2026

July 1

15:20 – 16:05



*Fact-Checking and Verification
in the AI Era*

Dhanyashri Kamalakannan

The Pranava Institute



Q&A



Online Mentoring Programme

GLOBAL YOUTH HACKATHON 2026

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#GlobalMILWeek2026





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#YouthHackathon2026

July 2

13:00 – 13:45

Children, Youth and Media



Sherri Hope Culver

Temple University



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July 2

13:50 – 14:35

Digital Content Creators and MIL

Elizabeth Sherr

Science Communicator and
Content Creator





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July 2

14:40 – 15:25

*Building Partnerships &
Community Engagement*

Sandra Acero

CIVIX Colombia





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#YouthHackathon2026

July 2

15:30 – 16:15



How to Design Your Hackathon Project?



Dun Concha Abiera

Work Beyond Borders

Submission

Dedicated Submission Portal

- The dedicated portal will be shared **6 of July** via email and our website
- Only a successful submission will confirm your team's participation in Youth Hackathon 2026
- All team members of a successfully submitted project that **aligns with the MIL theme will receive a certificate from UNESCO**
- Provide **accurate team information** to ensure the following communication
- Each team should choose **ONE member** to submit the project on behalf of the team
- Please **avoid multiple submissions** unless a re-submission is really necessary

Two Components

- Proposal in Word / PDF format (English only, 10 MB maximum)
- A pitch video (within 3 minutes)

Deadline: 16 August 23:59 Paris Time

Contact

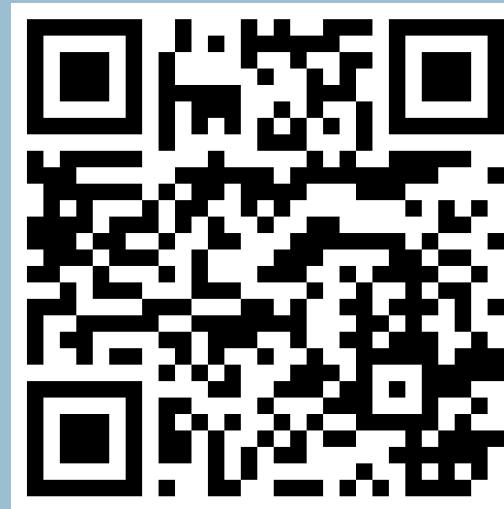
Please update yourself through:



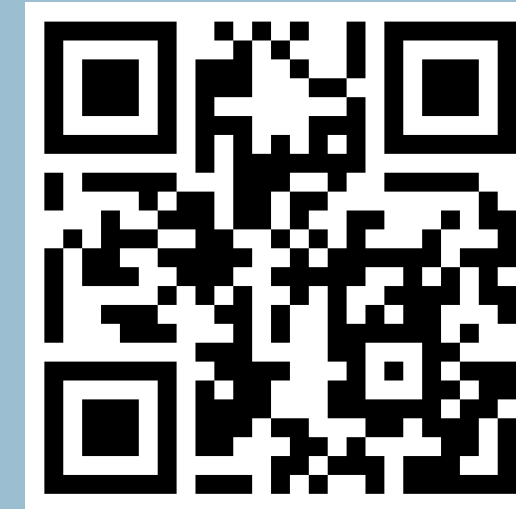
UNESCO MIL
Webpage



Youth Hackathon
2026 Webpage



Instagram



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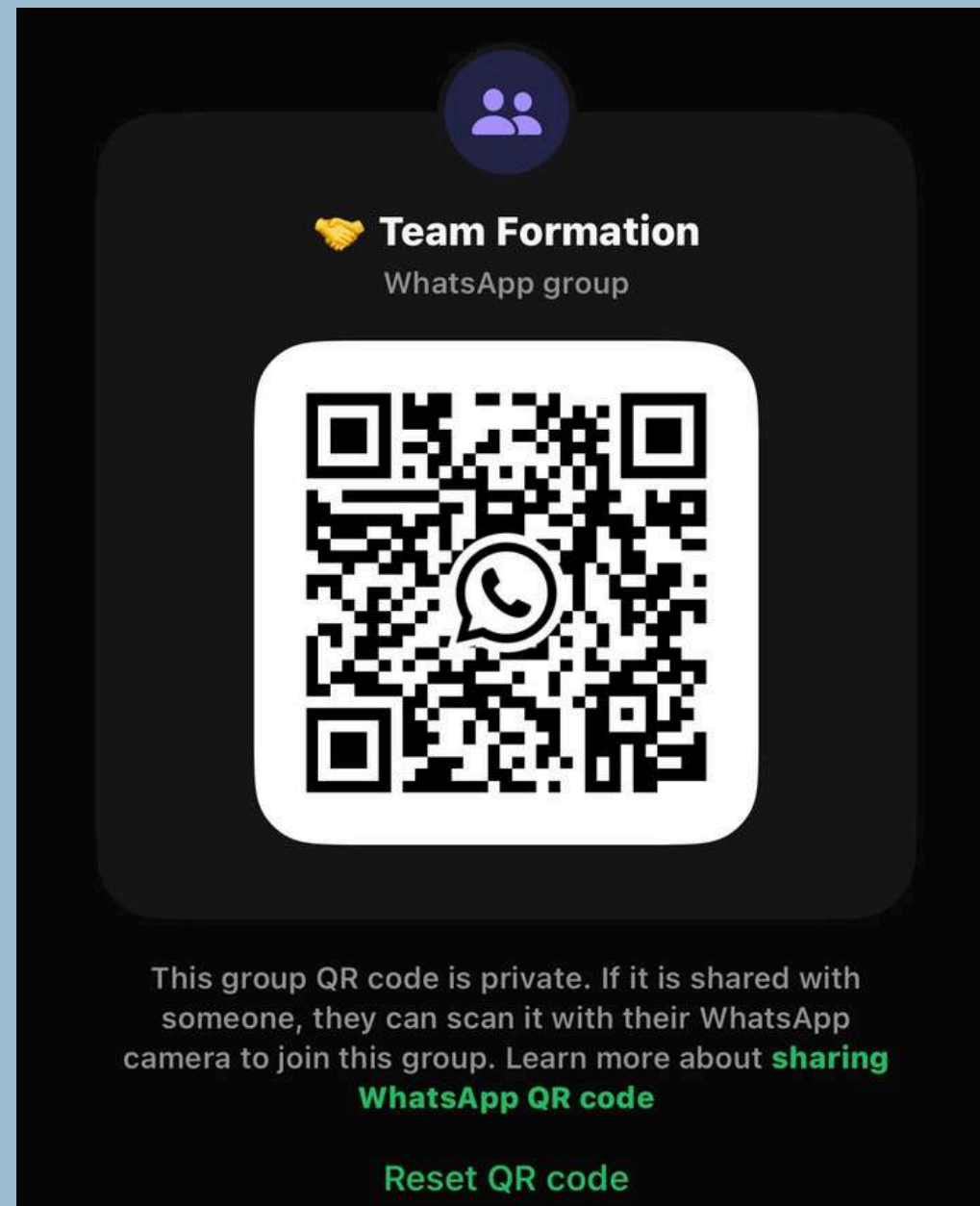
Facebook

Email: milunit@unesco.org / d.min@unesco.org

FQA

- What is the format for the proposal?
- What should I include in the video?
- Age eligibility
- The time zone
- The language
- Team members update/information update
- Do I need my project fully work? Or it can be at a prototype stage?
- When can we get the results/what can winners receive?
- Can we get the recording of this session? When?
- Can we get the certificate of participation afterwards?
- Team creation? Can UNESCO help us to find team members?

Official Channel



If you are having some problems to form a team, you can join the dedicated community by scanning the QR Code.

Please introduce yourself by sharing your name, country/region, skills, areas of interest, and the type of teammates you are looking for.

 Join via the Link:
<https://chat.whatsapp.com/GGpyx9lqgxcCdm0w7CQBal>

Please note:

UNESCO only facilitates this networking space. The formation of teams, the selection of teammates, and all subsequent collaboration and project development are entirely the responsibility of participants. UNESCO is not involved in team matching, team management, or agreements between participants.

Final Q&A

Looking forward to your project
See you in Greece!

